PARADOX

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Chapter 1: The Echo of Glass

NASA ke Headquarters mein ab Ishaan ke liye koi darwaza band nahi tha. Safed chamakti hui deewaren, har kone mein lage high-tech sensors, aur logon ki nazron mein uske liye behisaab izzat—ye sab ab uski aadat ban chuka tha. Do saal pehle ka wo 'Invisible Boy' ab 'Global Icon' tha.

Par Ishaan ka dimaag ab bhi wahi pichli seat wala tha. Use ab bhi bheed se darr lagta tha. Uske liye NASA ke ye corridors sirf ek rasta the us lab tak pahunchne ka, jahan wo aur **Professor Kenji** Indovar se mile data ko decode kar rahe the.

"Ishaan, tum fir se soye nahi?" Kenji ne uske kandhe par hath rakha. Kenji ki awaaz mein ek pita jaisi fikr thi.

"Sir, Indovar ke signals... wo linear nahi hain. Wo circular hain. Jaise koi cheez baar-baar repeat ho rahi ho," Ishaan ne apni laal aankhon se screen ki taraf dekha.

"Chhodo ye sab. Aaj Anjali ne tumhare liye khaas Indian dinner banaya hai. No science tonight," Kenji ne muskurate hue kaha.

Chapter 2:The Silence in the Kitchen

Kenji ka ghar NASA ke paas hi ek purane par khoobsurat ilake mein tha. **Anjali**, Kenji ki patni, Ishaan ke liye us maa jaisi thi jise usne kabhi dhang se mehsoos nahi kiya tha. Wo usse physics nahi, uski pasand ke khaane aur uske bachpan ki baatein karti thi.

Dinner table par hansi-mazaak chal raha tha. "Ishaan, agli baar jab India jao, toh mere liye wo khaas banarasi dupatta zaroor lana," Anjali ne hanste hue kaha.

"Zaroor, Aunty. Agli baar pakka," Ishaan ne muskura kar jawab diya.

Tabhi, Anjali kitchen ki taraf gayi dessert lane. Kenji aur Ishaan Indovar ke gravitational pull par bahes karne hi wale the ki achanak— **"KHADAAAK!"**

Bartan girne ki ek bhayanak awaaz aayi. Pehle sannata hua, aur phir ek bhari cheez ke girne ki awaaz.

Ishaan aur Kenji dono ek saath daude. Kitchen ke farsh par Anjali giri hui thi. Uska chehra peela pad chuka tha aur saansein ruk rahi thi.

"Anjali! Anjali, aankhein kholo!" Kenji ne use god mein uthaya, uske hath kaanp rahe the. Ishaan ne turant emergency dial kiya, par uske andar ka scientist use bata raha tha ki waqt nikal chuka hai.

Hospital pahunchte hi doctor ne bas sar hila diya. **Cardiac Arrest.** Wahi insaan jisne space-time ko samajhne ka dawa kiya tha, ek dhadkan ko rukne se nahi bacha paya.

Chapter 3: The Last Journey: Ganga Ghat

Kenji poori tarah toot gaya tha. Wo NASA ka hoshiyaar scientist ab sirf ek bebas pati tha. Anjali ki aakhri khwahish thi ki uska antim sanskar India ki mitti mein ho.

Ek Dinn baad, Ishaan, Kenji aur **Professor Mikhail** Banaras ke harishchandra ghat par khade the. Charo taraf vedic mantron ki goonj thi. Ganga ka thanda pani aur jalte hue diye. Agni dete waqt Kenji ke hath kaanp rahe the.

Ishaan door khada ye sab dekh raha tha. Usne dekha ki kaise ek jeeta-jaagta insaan raakh mein badal gaya. Usne apni mutthi bheenchi. 'Waqt... sabse bada dushman waqt hai,' usne socha.

"Ishaan..." Mikhail ne uske paas aakar dhire se kaha. "Physics mein hum kehte hain energy kabhi khatam nahi hoti. Shayad wo ab bhi kahin hai."

Ishaan ne Mikhail ki taraf dekha, uski aankhon mein ek ajeeb si chamak thi. "Energy khatam nahi hoti Mikhail, par waqt use humse chheen leta hai. Mujhe waqt ko rokna hoga. Mujhe piche jana hoga."

Mikhail hairan reh gaya. "Kya keh rahe ho? Time travel ek theory hai, suicide hai!"

"Nahi," Ishaan ne jalte hue ghat ki taraf dekhte hue kaha. "Indovar ke signals circular the kyunki waqt khud ek circle hai. Hume bas us circle mein enter karna hai."

Chapter 4: The Secret Lab and The Convergence

Banaras se lautne ke baad Ishaan pehle jaisa nahi raha tha. Usne NASA se chutti li aur Delhi ke outer area mein ek purani warehouse ko apni secret lab mein badal diya. Yahan na koi media thi, na koi government interference—sirf Ishaan aur uski 'impossible' equations thi.

Ek thandi subah, lab ke bhari steel darwaze khule. **Bhuvan** aur **Avika** andar dakhil hue. Unke saath **Kenji** aur **Mikhail** bhi the. Ye pehli baar tha jab ye paanchon ek hi chat ke niche the.

Lab ke beech mein ek vishalkay holographic sphere chamak raha tha, jisme Indovar aur Earth ke orbits ka ek complex jaal tha.

"Chhote, ye sab kya hai? Tu theek toh hai na?" Bhuvan ne aage badhkar Ishaan ke kandhe par hath rakha. Bhuvan ab ISRO ka ek kabil scientist tha, uske chehre par ab ek zimmedari dikhti thi.

Ishaan ne mudkar dekha. Uske baal bikhre hue the aur aankhon mein ek ajeeb si junooniyat thi. "Bhai, main pehle se behtar hoon. Kyunki ab mujhe rasta mil gaya hai."

Tabhi Mikhail ne apni jacket utari aur lab ke gadgets ko bade dhyan se dekhne lagi. Bhuvan ki nazar Mikhail par padi. Mikhail ki blue eyes aur uske kaam karne ka 'sharp' tareeka dekh kar Bhuvan ke chehre par ek shararati smile aa gayi.

"Mikhail, sahi kaha na?" Bhuvan ne Mikhail ki taraf hath badhaya. "Suna tha Russian scientists bohot hoshiyaar hote hain, par ye nahi pata tha ki wo itne charming bhi hote hain."

Mikhail ke gore gaal thode gulabi ho gaye. Usne ek halki smile di aur Bhuvan se hath milaya. "Aur maine suna tha Indians bohot emotional hote hain, par aapka humor toh kaafi advanced hai."

Lab ka bhari mahaul thoda halka ho gaya. Kenji ne khaste hue sabka dhyan holographic board ki taraf kheencha.

Chapter 5: The 100x Theory

Ishaan ne screen par ek data stream chalayi. "Sir, Indovar ka orbit normal nahi hai. Maine calculate kiya hai ki Indovar ek 'Gravity Slingshot' ki tarah kaam karta hai. Agar hum ek spaceship ko Indovar ke orbit ke itne kareeb le jayein jahan uska gravitational pull max ho, aur wahan se hum **$100\times$** ki velocity hit karein... toh hum space-time ko bend kar sakte hain."

Poori lab mein sannata cha gaya. Kenji ki aankhein fati ki fati reh gayi. "Ishaan, tum samajh rahe ho tum kya keh rahe ho? $100\times$ speed par spaceship atoms mein toot jayega! Aur itni energy layenge kahan se?"

"Wahi sabse badi problem thi, sir," Ishaan ne ek purana digital map khola. "Hume ek aise fuel ki zaroorat hai jo fission ya fusion se nahi, balki direct 'Matter-Antimatter' collision ko handle kar sake. Maine ise **'A-Eendhan'** (A-Fuel) naam diya hai."

"Ye milega kahan?" Avika ne pucha. Wo science nahi samajhti thi, par wo Ishaan ka darr samajhti thi.

"65 million saal pehle, jab wo vishalkay asteroid dharti se takraya tha jisne dinosaurs ko khatam kiya... wo sirf pathar nahi tha. Uske core mein 'A-Eendhan' ke crystals the. Us collision ka asar itna bhayanak tha ki wo crystals Pacific Ocean ki sabse gehri khaai—Mariana Trench ke niche dab gaye."

Chapter 6: Descent into the Abyss

Teen din baad, wo paanchon ek specially design kiye gaye 'Alien Pod' (jo Indovar se mila tha) mein baithe Pacific Ocean ke beech khade ek ship par the. Sumandar ki lehrein kaafi unchi uth rahi thi, jaise wo unhe niche jaane se rok rahi honi.

"Sab taiyar?" Ishaan ne pucha. Sabne gardan hilayi. Pod dhire-dhire pani ke andar utarne laga.

Jaise-jaise wo gehrai mein ja rahe the, bahar ka nazaara badal raha tha. Pehle neela pani, phir gehra hara, aur anth mein—bilkul kaala andhera. Pod ki heavy floodlights ne jab samundar ki satah (floor) ko chhuna, toh wahan ka manzar dekh kar sabke hosh udd gaye.

Wahan koi machliyan nahi thi. Wahan ajeeb se vishalkay kankal (skeletons) bikhre hue the.

"Wahan dekho!" Avika chilla uthi.

Dhund ke beech se ek vishalkay parchayi ubhri. Wo itni badi thi ki pod uske saamne ek chote khilone jaisa lag raha tha. Uske sharir par purane zamaane ke ship ke anchors aur kachre chipke hue the. Uski aankhein ek kamre jitni badi thi aur wo chamak rahi thi.

"**Leviathan...**" Ishaan ne dhire se kaha. "Dharti ka aakhri pehredaar. Ye us asteroid ke malbe se nikle fuel ki energy par zinda hai."

Leviathan ne pod ki taraf ek bhayanak roar kiya. Pani ke andar vibration itni tez thi ki pod ke sheeshe chatakne lage. Mikhail ne tezi se controls sambhale. "Ishaan! Ye hume kacha chaba jayega! Fuel nikal aur yahan se bhaag!"

Ishaan ne robotic arm activate ki. Usne dekha ki ek chamakta hua violet crystal Leviathan ke theek niche ek chattan mein dhasa hua tha. Leviathan ne apna bhari panja pod par maara.

"Pakad liya!" Ishaan ne chillate hue crystal ko kheench liya. Leviathan fir se hamla karne wala tha, par Ishaan ne pod ke thrusters full power par on kar diye.

Wo log goli ki raftar se upar ki taraf bhage, peeche Leviathan ki wo khaufnaak dahaad poore samundar mein goonj rahi thi. Unke paas ab wo chabi thi, jo waqt ka darwaza khol sakti thi.

Chapter 7: The Rejected Suit

Leviathan ke fuel crystals milne ke baad lab mein kaam ki raftar dugni ho gayi thi. Ishaan ne din-raat ek kar diye the. Lab ke center mein ab wo purana pod nahi, balki ek revolutionary ship khadi thi—**'Waqt-Rath'**. Iska design sleek tha, aur iski body par ek special reflective coating thi jo space-time ke friction ko jhel sake.

"Ishaan, ye suits taiyar hain," Mikhail ne kaha, six metallic-grey suits dikhate hue. Ye suits wearer ki body temperature aur pressure ko stabilize karne ke liye bane the.

Ishaan ne ek suit uthakar uske sensors check kiye. "Mikhail, ye sixth wala suit... iska data theek nahi lag raha."

"Oh, wo prototype hai. Uska **$T-Shift$ tolerance** bohot low hai. High velocity par ye suit pehenne wale ki skin se merge ho sakta hai ya fir portal ke beech mein hi crash kar sakta hai," Mikhail ne samjhaya.

Ishaan ne us suit par ek bada laal 'X' mark kiya. "Ye kisi kaam ka nahi hai. Ise reject karo. Hume koi risk nahi chahiye." Usne wo suit ek kachre ke container mein dalwa diya, bina ye soche ki kachra bhi kabhi 'aatma-ghati' ho sakta hai.

Chapter 8: The Shadow of Manvik

Idhar sheher ke ek purane bar mein Manvik baitha tha. Uska chehra bikhra hua tha aur aankhon mein ek ajeeb si jalan thi. Ishaan ki success ne use har jagah se 'reject' karwa diya tha. Uske baap ka business doob chuka tha, aur log use ab sirf 'wo ladka jisne Ishaan ko bully kiya tha' ke naam se jaante the.

Lekin uski sabse badi haar Avika thi. Use pata chala tha ki Avika aaj kal Ishaan ke saath uski secret lab mein rehti hai.

"Wo bas ek coder hai... ek loser," Manvik ne apne glass ko zor se table par patka. Usne thaan liya tha ki wo Avika ko wapas lekar rahega, chahe kuch bhi ho jaye.

Agli shaam, jab Avika lab se thodi der ke liye bahar nikli, Manvik uske raaste mein aa khada hua.

"Avika! Ruk jao, please meri baat suno," wo gidgidane laga.

Avika ne piche mudkar dekha, uski aankhon mein nafrat nahi, balki taras tha. "Manvik, tum yahan kya kar rahe ho? Tumhari halat dekho... move on karo."

"Move on? Kaise? Tum us Ishaan ke saath ho? Wo tumhe khatre mein daal raha hai, Avika. Wo pagal ho chuka hai!"

"Wo pagal nahi hai, Manvik. Wo genius hai. Aur humare beech sab khatam ho gaya hai. Dobara mere piche mat aana," Avika ne sapat lehze mein kaha aur lab ke andar chali gayi.

Manvik wahi khada raha. Usne dekha ki lab ke piche wale gate se kachre ke bade containers bahar nikale ja rahe the. Uska dimaag gusse aur jalan mein shaitani chalne laga. Usne containers ke beech ek chamakta hua metallic suit dekha—wahi suit jise Ishaan ne reject kiya tha.

Chapter 9: The Final Countdown

Lab ke andar launch ki taiyariyan aakhri stage par thi. Bhuvan aur Mikhail systems check kar rahe the.

"Bhuvan, oxygen levels check karo," Mikhail ne screen se nazrein bina hataye kaha.

"Levels perfect hain, Boss," Bhuvan ne mazaak mein salute kiya. "Waisa Mikhail, agar hum wapas aa gaye... toh kya tum mere saath ek 'desi' dinner par chaloge?"

Mikhail thoda hichkichaya, phir halka sa muskura kar bola, "Pehle wapas aao, phir menu decide karenge."

Ishaan ne sabko awaaz di. "Waqt ho gaya hai. A-Eendhan load ho chuka hai. Indovar ki orbit hume ek ghante mein hit karni hai."

Isi beech, andhere ka fayda uthakar Manvik ne wo rejected suit pehna. Suit defective tha, uske sensors red flash kar rahe the, par Manvik ko sirf Avika dikh rahi thi. Wo ship ke supply container mein, jahan extra oxygen tanks rakhe the, usmein chhup kar baith gaya.

"Ishaan, ye container itna bhari kyun lag raha hai?" Mikhail ne loading crane chalate waqt pucha. Usne sensors par ek 'extra mass' notice kiya tha.

Ishaan ne haste hue cockpit se jawab diya, "Kaamchori mat kar Mikhail! Wo extra backup tanks hain. Bas loading khatam kar aur andar aa!"

Mikhail ne kandhe uchkaye aur loading khatam ki. Use kya pata tha ki wo maut ko onboard le raha hai.

Chapter 10:The Breach

Waqt-Rath ne dharti ka atmosphere chhoda aur Indovar ki orbit mein dakhil hua. Indovarians ke ships ne turant hamla shuru kar diya, par Ishaan ka target unse ladna nahi tha.

"Velocity 80times... 90times... Ishaan, hum limit hit kar rahe hain!" Kenji chilla utha.

Jaise hi ship ne **100times** ki speed hit ki, space-time vibrate hone laga. Ship ke supply container ka gate us bhayanak vibration se dheela ho gaya aur achanak—**KHADAAAK!**

Gate khul gaya. Manvik, jo suit pehen kar container mein chipka hua tha, wo gravity ka jhatka jhel nahi paya. Defective suit ke thrusters apne aap on ho gaye aur wo space-time ke us kaale andhere 'void' mein gir gaya.

"Ye kya tha?" Avika ne piche mudkar dekha.

"Mass drop hua hai! Supply container eject ho gaya shayad," Ishaan ne tezi se controls sambhale. Ship ek vishalkay Nebula mein ja giri.

Charo taraf purplish-blue dhund thi. Wahan unhe kuch ajeeb roshniyan dikhayi di. SAHAY ka translator apne aap on ho gaya.

"Welcome, Travelers... Hum Nebulians hain," ek goonjti hui awaaz aayi. Unhe pata chala ki wahan ek bhayanak war chal rahi thi Life Syrup ke liye.jo kisike bhi death ko rok skta Unhone dekha ki kaise ek senior Nebulian ne apni jaan dau pr lga kr the most injurious venom ko absord krliya aur apne logon ko bachaya.

Chapter 11: The Origin

Nebula ki us purplish dhund se nikalte hi, Waqt-Rath ne ek aise dimension mein entry li jahan "Waqt" (Time) ka koi wajood nahi tha. Har taraf sirf safed, andhi kar dene wali roshni thi. Ship ke saare indicators fail ho chuke the.

"Ishaan! Speedometer zero dikha raha hai, par hum light se bhi tez travel kar rahe hain!" Mikhail ne ghabrate hue kaha.

Ishaan ne cockpit ka sheesha dekha. Baahar ka nazaara aisa tha jaise koi vishalkay artist poore bramhand ko ek bindu (point) mein samet raha ho. Wahan dhire-dhire kuch vishalkay aakriti (figures) ubharne lagi. Wo insaan jaise the, par roshni se bane hue—kam se kam 50 feet unche. Unke har movement se nayi galaxies ban rahi thi.

"Main bahar ja raha hoon," Ishaan ne dhire se kaha. Usne apna helmet lock kiya aur ship ka chamber khola.

Jaise hi wo bahar nikla, use koi pressure mehsoos nahi hua. Use laga jaise wo kisi thande pani ke pool mein tair raha ho. Ek vishalkay roshni ka sharir uske samne aaya. Uska chehra hamesha badal raha tha—kabhi wo ek bacche jaisa lagta, kabhi ek boodhe jaisa.

"Tum kaun ho?" Ishaan ne pucha. Uski awaaz uske helmet ke andar nahi, balki uske dimaag mein goonji.

"Hum Cristosapiens hain," wo awaaz hazaron bijliyon ke kadakne jaisi thi, par usmein ek ajib sukoon tha. "Tumhare planet par hume 'Bhagwan' kaha jata hai. Par hum chamatkar nahi hain, Ishaan. Hum ultra-advanced science hain, jo itni purani hai ki tumhare dimaag ke liye ye jadu lagta hai."

Ishaan hairan tha. "Kya aapne hi hume banaya hai?"

"Humne tumhare planet par 9 times apne power kotumhare planet ke diffenrent species mei transfer kiya h. Har baar jab tumhara planet tabaahi ki kagar par tha, humne apni technology aur gyan un avatars ke roop mein bheja taaki tumhari prajati (species) bachi rahe. Humne 9 baar tumhe tabaah hone se bachaya hai... par 10vi baar (The 10th Avatar) shayad tumhe khud ko bachana hoga."

Ishaan ne pucha, "Kya main waqt badal sakta hoon? Kya main unhe bacha sakta hoon jo chale gaye?"

Cristosapiens thoda piche hate. Unki aankhon mein ek dard bhari chamak thi. "Waqt ek dhaga nahi hai jise tum tod sako, Ishaan. Waqt ek 'Loop' hai. Jo hua hai, wo hoga. Aur jo ho raha hai, wo pehle hi ho chuka hai."

Ek jhatke ke saath, Cristosapiens gayab ho gaye aur Ishaan wapas ship ke andar fenk diya gaya. Ship wapas Earth ki taraf tezi se badhne lagi.

Chapter 12: The Homecoming and The Hidden Scar

Earth par wapas lautne ke baad sab kuch badal gaya tha. Duniya ke liye wo paanchon maut ke muh se wapas aaye heroes the.

Bhuvan aur Mikhail ki shaadi hui. Us shaadi mein Ishaan ne dekha ki kaise do alag-alag duniya ke log ek ho sakte hain. Mikhail ne Bhuvan ke liye 'Kurta' pehna tha aur Bhuvan ne Mikhail se Russian mein "I love you" bolna seekh liya tha.

Ishaan ne Avika ko wo special bracelet gift kiya jise usne space-time ke us junction par banaya tha. "Ye tumhe hamesha mere paas rakhega," Ishaan ne Avika ka hath thama. Avika muskura di, par uski aankhon mein ab bhi wo 'War Universe' ka darr kahin chipa tha.

Lekin is khushi ke piche, andhere mein ek bhayanak sach pal raha tha.

Shaam ka dhundhlaka charo taraf phail raha tha. Sheher ki ek sunsaan gali mein, purani deewar ke sahare nanha Ishaan ghutno mein sar diye baitha tha. Uska school bag thoda door mitti mein pada tha. Aaj bullies ne use itni buri tarah maara tha ki uske sharir se zyada uski rooh dukh rahi thi. Wo sisak raha tha, ye soch kar ki kya wo hamesha aise hi sabke liye 'invisible' rahega.

Tabhi, us gali ki hawa achanak bhari hone lagi. Sannate ko chirte hue ek ajeeb si charcharahat hui, jaise koi purana panna beech se phat raha ho. Aasmaan mein ek neeli darar khuli aur usme se ek aakriti (figure) bahar giri.

Wo **Manvik** tha.

Uska sharir us jale hue, adhe-toote 'Prototype Suit' ke saath buri tarah fuse ho chuka tha. Suit ki nanotech wires uski khaal ke andar naso ki tarah ubhri hui thi, jo har saans ke saath chamak rahi thi. Manvik ke chehre par dard, nafrat aur ek ajeeb sa sukoon tha.

Wo ladkhadate kadmon se nanhe Ishaan ki taraf badha. Ishaan ne darr ke maare apna sar uthaya. Usne dekha ek bhayanak, adha-insaani chehra jo uski taraf jhuk raha tha. Nanha Ishaan kuch bolna chahta tha, par uske gale se awaaz nahi nikli.

Manvik ne apna bhari, metallic haath dhire se uthaya. Uske kaanpte hue haath ki unglian nanhe Ishaan ke sar tak pahunchi.

Manvik ne apna haath Ishaan ke sar par rakha.

Gali mein ek pal ke liye sab kuch tham gaya. Nanhe Ishaan ki neeli aankhein fati ki fati reh gayi aur Manvik ne apni aankhein band kar li. Bas wahi ek sparsh (touch) tha, aur sadiyon ka sannata.